

CARIBBEAN EARNER SERIES



DELIVERY BUSINESS BLUEPRINT

BUILD YOUR OWN DELIVERY ROUTE.
GET PAID WITHOUT THE PLATFORM TAKING 30%.

REAL SKILLS. REAL INCOME. NO HYPE.



CARIBSTREAM.IO

Delivery Business Blueprint

Build Your Own Delivery Route. Get Paid Without the Platform Taking 30%.

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INCOME BENCHMARKS

\$4,000–\$8,000/month at full direct route capacity · platform income supplements direct clients · Caribbean restaurants pay 12–15% vs platform's 25–30%

The Delivery Business Opportunity

Platforms as your launch pad. Your own direct route as your destination.

DoorDash, Amazon Flex, Uber Eats, and Instacart generated over \$150 billion in delivery revenue collectively. The platforms provide the technology, the brand, and the client base. They also take 20–30% of every order as their commission. Your goal is to use the platforms to build income, learn your delivery zone, and identify the direct clients who will pay you 12–15% instead of the platform's 25–30%. The platform is the training ground. The direct route is the business.

\$150B

Combined delivery platform revenue · platforms take 25–30% · direct client relationships pay you 12–15% · the gap is your margin

Why Direct Clients Change the Math

A Caribbean restaurant doing \$5,000 per week in delivery orders pays DoorDash \$1,250–\$1,500 per week in platform fees. If you offer to handle their delivery for 12–15%, you save them \$600–\$900 per week and you earn \$600–\$750/week from one client. That restaurant owner knows this math. They just have not had a trusted Caribbean delivery professional show up and offer the alternative — until you.

Platform income — the bridge

Amazon Flex: \$18–\$25/hour guaranteed blocks. DoorDash and Uber Eats: \$15–\$22/hour in peak zones. Instacart: \$20–\$30/hour with large order bonuses. Platforms pay consistently while you build your direct client relationships. Never quit the platforms until direct client income exceeds platform income.

Direct client income — the destination

Caribbean restaurant at \$5,000/week delivery volume at 13%: \$650/week from one client. Five Caribbean restaurants at similar volume: \$3,250/week — \$13,000/month from five direct relationships. Same car. Same hours. No platform taking 27%.

Barbados built the Caribbean's most reliable transportation infrastructure through disciplined investment in systems that outlast any single operator. Your delivery business is a system — not just a car and a phone. Build the system first.

Platform Launch Strategy

Which platforms to start with, how to qualify, and how to maximize earnings.

The platform phase is your training ground and your income bridge. Use it to learn delivery logistics, identify high-demand areas, and build your reputation in the delivery space while your direct client pipeline develops. Every platform has different strengths — know which one to prioritize based on your city and your vehicle.

1**Amazon Flex — Highest Guaranteed Pay**

Amazon Flex pays \$18–\$25/hour for 3–4 hour delivery blocks with guaranteed block pay regardless of order volume. Apply at flex.amazon.com. Requirements: smartphone, valid driver's license, vehicle insurance, ability to lift 50 pounds. Amazon Flex is your most reliable platform income — no surge pricing needed, no waiting for orders. Book blocks in advance and know exactly what you earn before you start.

2**DoorDash — Volume and Flexibility**

DoorDash operates in virtually every US city with active Caribbean communities. Sign up at dasher.doordash.com. No minimum hours. Dash when you want. Peak pay hours are Friday and Saturday dinner (5–9pm) and weekend lunch (11am–2pm) — target these windows for \$18–\$25/hour effective rates. Use DoorDash heat maps in the app to position yourself in high-demand zones before going online.

3**Instacart — Highest Per-Hour Potential**

Instacart grocery delivery pays \$20–\$35/hour on large orders with generous customer tip culture. Apply at instacart.com/shoppers. The learning curve is steeper — you shop and deliver — but the per-hour rate in Caribbean neighborhoods with large family grocery orders is the highest of any platform. Caribbean shoppers order large. Large orders tip well.

4

Maximizing Platform Income

Work multiple platforms simultaneously using the multi-apping strategy: accept an Amazon Flex block as your base, turn on DoorDash between Amazon stops, and check Instacart for high-value batches. Your phone manages three apps. Your car completes deliveries in the same zones. Your hourly effective rate rises to \$25–\$35/hour across platforms in peak windows.

TARGET INCOME ON PLATFORMS

Week 1–4 target: \$800–\$1,200/week on platforms working 30–35 hours. Month 2 target with multi-apping: \$1,200–\$1,600/week. Use this income to fund your direct client outreach — business cards, a simple booking page, and time spent building relationships in the Caribbean restaurant community.

Building Your Direct Client Route

The transition from platform dependency to owning your delivery relationships.

A direct client pays you 12–15% of order value instead of the platform's 20–30%. For a Caribbean restaurant doing \$5,000 per week in delivery orders, that difference is \$600–\$900 per week — money that was going to a platform and is now split between you and the restaurant owner. You earn more. They pay less. The platform loses a client. This is the transition every serious delivery operator makes.

1

Identifying Direct Client Candidates

During your platform delivery runs, identify which restaurants, caterers, and food businesses are generating the highest delivery volume. Note which Caribbean restaurants you deliver from most frequently. These businesses are already spending on delivery — they just need an alternative. Keep a running list of your top 10 platform delivery sources. These become your direct client prospects.

2

The Direct Client Pitch

Approach the owner directly — not during a delivery. Request a 10-minute meeting. 'I deliver from your restaurant through DoorDash regularly. I want to offer you direct delivery at 13% of order value versus the 27% you are paying DoorDash. I provide the same delivery speed, I know your neighborhood, and you save \$700 per week on the same volume.' Bring the math on paper. Let the numbers close the deal.

3

Setting Up the Direct Delivery Agreement

A one-page direct delivery agreement covers: service area, delivery fee structure (percentage or flat rate per order), payment terms (weekly via Zelle or direct deposit), response time guarantee, and exclusivity terms if applicable. Keep it simple. Caribbean business owners respond to straightforward agreements that protect both parties without requiring a lawyer to read.

4

Maintaining Platform Income During Transition

Do not quit any platform until your direct client income replaces it. Build direct clients one at a time over 60–90 days while maintaining your platform earnings. By month 3, if you have 3–4 direct clients generating \$2,500–\$3,500/week, you can reduce platform hours and focus on growing the direct route. The transition is gradual by design.

Caribbean Community Clients — Your Warmest Accounts

Caribbean restaurants, caterers, barrel shipping, and businesses that trust you first.

Caribbean business owners in diaspora cities have been paying platform fees for years without ever having a Caribbean delivery professional show up and offer an alternative. You are the first. And when you walk into a Caribbean restaurant as a Caribbean professional who already knows their food, knows their neighborhood, and knows their community — the conversation is completely different from a generic delivery pitch.

1

Caribbean Restaurants — Your Anchor Clients

Caribbean restaurants have high delivery volume, loyal customer bases that order consistently, and owners who understand the value of community relationships. The Jamaican restaurant in your city that does \$8,000/week in orders is paying DoorDash \$2,160/week. Your offer at 13%: \$1,040/week — saving them \$1,120 per week. One yes from one Caribbean restaurant is \$1,040/week in guaranteed income.

2

Caribbean Caterers — Event and Weekly Delivery

Caribbean caterers serving diaspora communities prepare food for weekly church events, cultural gatherings, and private parties. They need consistent, reliable delivery to multiple drop-off points on specific schedules. Flat-rate event delivery (\$150–\$300 per event) plus weekly recurring delivery agreements (\$200–\$400/week) create predictable income with strong community relationships.

3

Caribbean Grocery and Specialty Stores

Caribbean grocery stores and specialty food shops serve customers who cannot always make it to the store. A weekly grocery delivery service for Caribbean families — Caribbean store to Caribbean home — is a service that does not exist in most cities. Price at \$25–\$40 per delivery. Build a recurring weekly route of 15–20 Caribbean family clients generating \$375–\$800/week.

4

Meal Prep and Home Cook Delivery

Caribbean home cooks who sell prepared meals through social media need delivery. A meal prep cook selling 30 meals per week at \$15/meal does \$450/week in revenue. Your delivery service at 15% + delivery fee = \$67.50–\$90/week from one home cook. Build a network of 10 Caribbean home cooks. Your delivery route becomes a Caribbean food ecosystem.

YOUR BUSINESS WEBSITE — PERSONAL NOTE

A professional booking page — showing your services, pricing, and availability — converts clients who find you online into booked jobs without a single cold call. I found it significantly easier to use Lovable — an AI site builder where you describe what you want and it builds a professional site in minutes. No coding required. caribstream.io/lovable

CARIBBEAN COMMUNITY INSIGHT — THE BARREL RUN

You don't always have to depend on the big platforms for delivery income. Keep in mind that someone in the Caribbean community is always sending barrels back home — and they might need those barrels picked up and dropped off to the shipping agent. Offering barrel pickup and drop-off delivery to Caribbean shipping agents in your city is a natural extension of your delivery business that no DoorDash competitor will ever think to offer. Talk to Caribbean shipping agents in your city about becoming their preferred local pickup driver.

Fleet Expansion and Driver Management

From one vehicle to a delivery operation that runs without you driving.

The delivery business scales through additional drivers operating under your direct client contracts. Once you have 3–4 direct clients generating consistent volume, a second driver doubles your capacity without doubling your hours. You manage the client relationships, the scheduling, and the quality. Your drivers handle the deliveries.

1

Your First Driver Hire

A second Caribbean driver you trust — a family member, a community contact, a reliable referral — extends your delivery capacity. Pay per delivery: \$8–\$12 per drop depending on distance and order size, or 60–65% of your per-delivery rate from the direct client. Your margin on every delivery your driver completes: 35–40%. You earn without driving.

2

Driver Requirements and Insurance

Every driver under your operation must carry their own auto insurance with delivery rider coverage. Some personal auto policies exclude commercial delivery use — verify every driver's coverage before they make a single delivery under your brand. Commercial auto insurance for your own vehicle: \$1,200–\$2,400/year. Non-negotiable.

3

Scheduling and Dispatch

A shared WhatsApp group with your drivers and direct clients handles scheduling for the first 5–10 drivers. At 10+ drivers, upgrade to a simple dispatch app — Track-POD or Route4Me both offer affordable plans for small fleets. Your direct clients text order volume for the day. You assign drivers. Drivers confirm completion. Simple, fast, traceable.

Operation	Drivers	Weekly Revenue	Net to You
Solo — direct clients	1 (you)	\$2,000–\$3,000	\$2,000–\$3,000
2 drivers — split routes	2	\$4,000–\$6,000	\$3,200–\$4,800

5 drivers — full network	5	\$10,000–\$15,000	\$6,000–\$9,000
10 drivers — delivery company	10	\$20,000–\$30,000	\$10,000–\$15,000

Pricing, Contracts, and Recurring Revenue

Structure direct client agreements that pay every month.

Direct client delivery pricing has two models: percentage of order value and flat rate per delivery. Caribbean restaurant clients respond best to the percentage model — they can see the direct comparison to what they are paying the platform. Grocery and catering clients often prefer flat rate per delivery or weekly flat-rate agreements that make budgeting predictable for both parties.

Client Type	Pricing Model	Rate	Monthly Revenue Est.
Caribbean restaurant	% of order value	12–15%	\$2,000–\$4,000
Catering delivery	Flat rate per event	\$150–\$300/event	\$600–\$1,200
Grocery delivery	Per delivery	\$25–\$40	\$800–\$1,600
Barrel/shipping runs	Per pickup + drop	\$40–\$75/run	\$400–\$800
Meal prep delivery	% + delivery fee	15% + \$5	\$400–\$800
TOTAL — 5 clients			\$4,200–\$8,400/mo

CARIBBEAN EARNER PRINCIPLE

Antigua's Sailing Week became a global institution because the Caribbean community built it from the inside — local knowledge, local investment, local pride, global reach. Your delivery network starts with one Caribbean restaurant and one Caribbean driver. Build from the inside out.

Build Your Route. Own Your Income. Stop Feeding the Platform.

Every Caribbean restaurant paying DoorDash 27% is a potential direct client. Every Caribbean home cook selling meals needs delivery. Every barrel going back home needs a pickup and drop-off. The delivery business is already happening in your community — you just need to own your piece of it.

YOUR FIRST 30-DAY ACTION PLAN

Week 1 — Platform setup

Sign up for Amazon Flex, DoorDash, and Instacart. Complete all verifications. Complete your first 20 platform deliveries to learn your zone.

Week 2 — Identify direct prospects

During your platform runs, note the top 5 Caribbean restaurants you deliver from. Research their delivery volume. Locate Caribbean shipping agents in your city for barrel pickup opportunities.

Week 3 — Pitch your first direct client

Approach one Caribbean restaurant owner directly with your 13% offer and the weekly savings calculation. Visit one Caribbean shipping agent about preferred pickup driver partnership.

Week 4 — Build the route

Add a second direct client. Continue platform income as bridge. Target \$2,000/week combined by end of month one.

KEY RESOURCES AND AFFILIATE LINKS

Business booking page (affiliate) — caribstream.io/lovable Amazon Flex signup — flex.amazon.com
DoorDash Dasher signup — dasher.doordash.com Instacart Shopper — instacart.com/shoppers
Delivery insurance rider — contact your auto insurer Route optimization — route4me.com or track-pod.com Caribbean shipping agents — search '[your city] Caribbean barrel shipping'

REAL SKILLS. REAL INCOME. NO HYPE.

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Caribbean adults abroad. Building wealth. Keeping roots.

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